Play in Context: Adapting Game-Based Learning for African Cultural Frameworks

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Abstract

Game-based learning (GBL) is widely recognized for its potential to enhance engagement and deepen learning, yet dominant models are shaped by Western paradigms that often overlook African cultural frameworks, linguistic diversity, and socio-economic realities. We argue for systemic adaptation of GBL grounded in Ubuntu pedagogy, postcolonial and decolonial game studies, and participatory culture principles. We introduce a Four-Layer Adaptation Framework addressing values, narrative sovereignty, participatory practices, and equity to guide culturally responsive design. Drawing on a South African pilot study, we illustrate how localized approaches foster inclusivity, collaboration, and cultural relevance while advancing Sustainable Development Goals. By reframing GBL through African epistemologies, this work positions Africa as an active innovator in game studies and offers a roadmap for equitable, context-sensitive educational game design.

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Keywords

Game-Based Learning, Ubuntu Pedagogy, Decolonial Game Studies, Participatory Culture, Culturally Responsive Design

Introduction

Game-based learning (GBL) and gamification have emerged as influential pedagogical innovations across global education systems. This paper emerges from our practice-based research and teaching in South African game design and health sciences education, where we have actively experimented with Ubuntu-informed GBL approaches. These approaches leverage the motivational and interactive qualities of games to enhance engagement, foster deeper learning, and support skill development (Roodt and Ryklief 2019). Dominant models of GBL are largely shaped by Western educational paradigms, embedding assumptions about pleasure, agency, and technological access that do not universally apply. Such models often overlook African cultural philosophies, linguistic diversity, and socio-economic realities, resulting in practices that lack contextual relevance. This disconnect constrains inclusivity and limits the transformative potential of GBL within African educational contexts, where structural inequities and cultural frameworks demand more nuanced approaches.

This paper takes the position that systemic adaptation of GBL is essential for African settings. We argue that adaptation must be grounded in Ubuntu pedagogy, a philosophy that emphasizes interdependence, dignity, and communal care, and informed by postcolonial and decolonial game studies, which critique the dominance of Eurocentric narratives in digital play. Our stance is that pleasure in play is deeply intersectional shaped by identity, resource access, and cultural norms rather than a universal experience. Imported gamification templates that prioritize competitive individualism and bandwidth-heavy delivery risk marginalizing learners in low-resource environments and perpetuating educational inequities. Addressing these risks requires a deliberate shift toward culturally responsive design principles that honour African epistemologies and lived realities.

To respond to these challenges, we propose a four-layer adaptation framework enriched by Ubuntu principles and participatory culture practices. This framework positions Africa, not as a passive recipient of global game-based learning trends, but as an active site of innovation within game studies. The paper proceeds as follows: first, we outline the theoretical foundations underpinning our argument, including Ubuntu pedagogy, postcolonial and decolonial game studies, and Jenkins' participatory culture framework (Jenkins, Ito, and boyd 2015). Next, we critique imported models of GBL and their

limitations in African contexts, highlighting structural and cultural misalignments. We then present our integrated adaptation framework and illustrate its application through a South African pilot study, demonstrating how localized design can enhance engagement and equity. Finally, we discuss implications for educational design and policy and conclude with a call to action for researchers, educators, and institutions to embrace culturally grounded approaches to game-based learning.

While some educators at the study site had begun engaging with game-based learning prior to this study, adoption was largely at an early or exploratory stage. Drawing on the author's MSc research in Health Sciences Education (Jankowitz 2024) as well as recent publications focusing on GBL at the site , evidence suggests that selected educators within the institution and across South African universities have experimented with digital and non-digital game-based approaches. These efforts were typically limited to pilot activities, informal use, or single-session gamification rather than sustained or programmatic implementation of digital game-based learning. As such, systematic data on educator practices and readiness remained limited, motivating the baseline mapping undertaken in Phase 1 of the study.

Theoretical Foundations: Ubuntu Pedagogy and Communal Learning in Gaming

Ubuntu pedagogy, rooted in the African philosophy of "*I am because we are*," emphasizes interconnectedness, collective well-being, empathy, cooperation, and cultural inclusivity (Walton and Engelbrecht 2022). In education, these principles foster socially just learning environments that prioritize collaboration over competition (Laughton et al. 2024, Ngubane and Makua 2021) and affirm diverse cultural identities (Mthimkhulu 2024). Game-based learning provides a powerful platform to operationalize Ubuntu values through cooperative mechanics, community-driven design, and inclusive participation that accommodates varied engagement styles (Farao et al. 2024, Rosenbaum 2024). Such approaches enhance learner engagement by making experiences interactive and culturally relevant (Shroff, Keyes, and Wee 2020), support 21st-century skills like communication and teamwork (Kereluik et al. 2010), and promote social-emotional development by strengthening empathy and communal bonds competition (Laughton et al. 2024, Ngubane and Makua 2021). However, successful implementation requires stakeholder buy-in and a shift toward valuing African knowledge systems, alongside careful design that balances communal priorities with individual learning needs (Mthimkhulu 2024). Addressing these

considerations is essential for creating sustainable, culturally grounded educational gaming practices.

Postcolonial and Decolonial Game Studies

Postcolonial and decolonial game studies critically interrogate how global GBL models often reproduce colonial tropes and market-driven logics unless they actively center Indigenous epistemologies and local player archetypes (Mukherjee and Hammar 2018). These approaches emphasize that pleasure in play is not universal but intersects with identity, language, and socio-economic constraints, making culturally grounded design choices essential for equity and inclusivity.

Games frequently reflect colonial ideologies by commodifying players' time, creativity, and identities for profit, aligning with neoliberal, state-controlled, or open-source ideologies that can undermine social justice and global citizenship (Keating, 2024). To counteract these dynamics, incorporating Indigenous knowledge systems into game design is critical. For example, *Never Alone* integrates Iñupiat culture into its narrative and interface design, demonstrating how collaboration with Indigenous communities can ensure authenticity and cultural richness (Evren, 2025). Similarly, games such as *Venba* challenge hegemonic representations by centering Indian Tamil Hindu diasporic experiences through food, language, and gendered labor, resisting cultural commodification and linguistic imperialism (Fernandez and Gaur 2025).

Beyond representation, Indigenous games and play serve as vital tools for cultural preservation and socio-emotional development. Research shows that Indigenous play in early childhood education promotes physical, socio-emotional, and academic growth, yet modern influences and safety concerns have led to its decline, underscoring the need for balanced educational strategies (Ekeh 2024). Decolonial game design principles advocate reframing play through linguistic humility, epistemic pluralism, design justice, and anti-essentialism, rejecting universality and neutrality in favour of contextual sensitivity and co-creation (Mota and Duarte 2026). These principles ensure that games reflect the plurality of global player experiences rather than perpetuating homogenized norms. However, implementing these principles presents challenges. Educators and designers must critically engage with Indigenous knowledge systems to avoid cultural appropriation and ensure meaningful inclusion, requiring specialized programs and pedagogical formats that advance Indigenous games and epistemologies (Hadebe-Ndlovu 2022). Emerging technologies such as virtual reality (VR) and augmented reality (AR) offer promising

strategies for cultural heritage preservation, providing immersive and interactive experiences that bridge traditional practices with digital expectations (Srdanović, Skala, and Maričević 2025). These innovations can enhance user engagement and education while safeguarding cultural authenticity.

Participatory Culture Framework

Henry Jenkins' (2009) participatory culture framework identifies eleven core media literacies play, performance, simulation, multitasking, collective intelligence, negotiation, among others that are essential for fostering collaboration, creativity, and learner agency in digital environments. These literacies enable learners to engage actively with content, assume multiple roles, and navigate complex social and technological landscapes. When implemented through inquiry-based learning, they promote active engagement and advance principles of equity and social justice (Jenkins, Ito, and boyd 2015, Jenkins et al. 2006).

The first literacy play involves exploratory and creative engagement with digital tools and environments, encouraging experimentation and problem-solving. Performance refers to adopting roles and enacting scenarios, which supports identity formation and critical reflection in learning contexts (Auman 2011). Simulation enables learners to understand and construct models of real-world processes, fostering systems thinking and applied knowledge (Fu, Sun, and Wang 2022). Multitasking develops the ability to manage multiple streams of information simultaneously, a skill increasingly necessary in digitally mediated learning spaces. Collective intelligence emphasizes pooling knowledge and collaborating with peers to solve problems, while negotiation focuses on navigating and respecting diverse perspectives within participatory environments (Jenkins, Ito, and boyd 2015).

Inquiry-based learning aligns closely with these literacies by positioning students as active participants in their learning process (Kori 2021). Through questioning, exploration, and reflection, learners engage deeply with content and collaborate meaningfully with peers. This approach fosters a participatory culture that empowers students to co-create knowledge rather than passively consume information.

Several pedagogical strategies illustrate how participatory culture can be operationalized. Digital storytelling in composition courses, for example, enables students to integrate rhetorical and multimodal elements into their work, enhancing engagement and

promoting social activism through creative expression (Jossan, Gauthier, and Jenkinson 2021). Similarly, cross-border projects that link teacher candidates from different countries expose learners to diverse cultural perspectives and new media technologies, strengthening their understanding of global citizenship and online participation (Meston, Whatman, and Bargallie 2025). Service-learning initiatives further extend participatory culture by encouraging students to address social justice issues, develop leadership skills, encourage social responsibility and engage with civic responsibilities in authentic contexts (Hadebe-Ndlovu 2022).

The framework also plays a critical role in promoting social justice. Incorporating new media literacies into social work education, for instance, enhances digital competencies and creates participatory learning environments that empower marginalized voices (Meston, Whatman & Bargallie, 2025; Dais-Mohadali, 2025; Hadebe-Ndlovu, 2022). Arts-informed methods within these programs provide experiential learning opportunities that foster personal transformation and challenge systemic inequities (Hadebe-Ndlovu, 2022). Despite its promise, implementing participatory culture in education presents challenges. Misinformation remains a significant concern, requiring the integration of critical digital literacy and media literacy into curricula to cultivate informed and discerning citizens (Keating 2024). Additionally, teacher training is essential to equip educators with the skills needed to manage digital tools effectively and promote critical thinking among learners (Ekeh 2024). Without comprehensive professional development, efforts to embed participatory culture risk being superficial or inconsistent. Building on these foundations, we now critique dominant GBL models and outline why adaptation is essential.

Argument

Western-centric GBL templates frequently assume competitive mechanics, high-bandwidth connectivity, and English-dominant interfaces. These assumptions conflict with African realities of multilingualism, infrastructural limitations, and communal learning traditions (Mukherjee and Hammar 2018, Walton and Engelbrecht 2022). Without adaptation, such models risk reinforcing exclusion and perpetuating epistemic dominance. Furthermore, competitive individualism embedded in many Western designs undermines African philosophies that prioritize collaboration and collective well-being, creating a misalignment between pedagogical goals and cultural values. This critique highlights the urgent need for systemic transformation rather than superficial localization.

Proponents of standardised GBL models argue that structured, globally applicable frameworks enhance scalability, efficiency, and alignment with international benchmarks, while reducing variability in learning outcomes (Fang and Strobel 2011) They emphasise that competitive mechanics can boost motivation and performance, and that English-dominant platforms support interoperability and wider adoption across contexts (Tang and Hanneghan 2011)Standardised models—such as instructional design frameworks, competency models for educators, and mechanics-driven approaches like MDA—are seen as essential for curriculum alignment, teacher support, and the scalable production of GBL resources (Jiang and Ziden 2025) Emerging frameworks further highlight adaptive learning, stealth assessment, and hybrid analytics as mechanisms to personalise learning while maintaining consistency and validity at scale (Aborokbah 2025)

However, these assumptions largely overlook the socio-cultural, linguistic, and infrastructural diversity of African educational contexts. Scalability without cultural responsiveness risks homogenisation, while competitive, individualised game mechanics may conflict with communal values that foreground collective success and relational learning. As such, adaptation is not optional but necessary for equity, relevance, and meaningful learning. A culturally responsive GBL approach must therefore challenge universalist design assumptions and deliberately embed African philosophies, values, and pedagogical traditions into both the design and implementation of game-based learning systems.

To operationalize this position, a South African university piloted an adapted approach in a video game design course with 74 students (Randle 2024). Using inquiry-based learning and participatory culture literacies, students co-created African-themed games addressing social issues. Seven Ubuntu-aligned themes guided implementation (Nxumalo and Mncube 2019, Mthimkhulu 2024, Choane 2025). First, inclusive education was promoted through mixed-gender teams collaborating on culturally relevant game narratives (Walton and Engelbrecht 2022). Second, gender sensitization was achieved by assigning female leadership roles and incorporating African aesthetics to challenge stereotypes (Ngunjiri 2016). Third, peer support and mentorship integrated academically strong and weak students within groups, fostering mutual learning and reducing hierarchical barriers (Swartz et al. 2016). Fourth, life orientation curriculum was embedded in game narratives to reflect local realities and social norms, promoting critical awareness and contextual relevance (Swartz et al. 2016). Fifth, conflict resolution and restorative justice were addressed through simulations that illustrated consequences of actions, encouraging

empathy and ethical decision-making (Du Plessis 2019). Sixth, student leadership and participation were strengthened through democratic decision-making processes that empowered students, particularly women, to take active roles in design and implementation (Ngubane and Makua 2021). Finally, parent and community involvement was facilitated through public showcases of student-created games, reinforcing Ubuntu values and fostering stakeholder engagement (Mthimkhulu 2024). It is suggested that Ubuntu-driven participatory design fosters teamwork, inclusivity, and cultural relevance while advancing Sustainable Development Goals (SDG) 4 on quality education and SDG 5 on gender equality (Mthimkhulu 2024).

Evidence further supports the effectiveness of culturally responsive GBL. Studies show that GBL improves academic achievement and engagement compared to traditional methods (Roodt and Ryklief 2022, Carenys, Moya, and Perramon 2017). Adaptive systems and intelligent tutoring enhance personalization, enabling learners to progress at their own pace and receive tailored feedback (Alamin et al. 2025, Shum et al. 2023, Moffat, Shabalina, and Khairov 2023). Importantly, inclusive design principles accommodate diverse learners, including those with disabilities, ensuring equitable access to educational opportunities (Kotnana, Sulaiman, and Jesudoss 2010). These findings underscore the need for frameworks that integrate cultural relevance with technological innovation to maximize learning outcomes.

The implications for design and policy are significant. First, participatory co-creation should engage educators, learners, and communities in game design processes to ensure cultural authenticity and relevance. Second, ethical and equity considerations must address algorithmic bias and epistemic dominance, preventing the reproduction of systemic inequalities in digital learning environments. Third, institutional strategies should embed Ubuntu principles into curricula and promote open-source resources to democratize access to educational technologies. Finally, policy alignment with SDG targets can ensure that GBL initiatives advance inclusive education and gender equality at scale.

The Four-Layer Adaptation Framework integrates Ubuntu principles and participatory culture, offering a contextually grounded approach rooted in African philosophies. It addresses systemic adaptation across policy, curriculum, design, and delivery, promoting inclusivity and cultural relevance. While currently conceptual, this framework provides a strong foundation for designing African-centric GBL strategies and driving policy and curriculum reform. Future work should focus on developing operational tools such as

metrics and templates and pairing the framework with implementation science to enable scalability and institutional adoption. In doing so, it positions institutions for decolonial pedagogy and sustainable transformation.

The Consolidated Framework for Implementation Research (CFIR) (Khan 2022) offers strong diagnostic capabilities by identifying barriers and enablers across multiple domains and has a robust evidence base in implementation science. Its complexity and need for specialized expertise, coupled with its focus on implementation rather than design, are notable limitations. CFIR is most effective for scaling GBL across faculties and planning institutional adoption.

The RE-AIM model emphasizes measurable outcomes for sustainability and equity, making it valuable for long-term impact assessment (King et al. 2020). Its quantitative orientation, however, makes it less suitable for cultural adaptation. RE-AIM is ideal for evaluating GBL interventions and reporting impact to funders and policymakers.

The ADKAR change management model provides simple, actionable steps for stakeholder buy-in and focuses on human factors in change processes (SixSigma.us Editorial 2025). Its limitation is the lack of guidance on pedagogy or technology design. ADKAR works best for driving educator adoption and supporting training and capacity-building initiatives.

The combined use of TPACK, SAMR, and UDL ensures pedagogical integrity and accessibility by aligning technology, pedagogy, and content, with UDL foregrounding equity (Kendon and Anselmo 2022, Bratitsis 2023). These models, however, originate from Western contexts and require significant contextualization for African settings. They are most useful for designing inclusive GBL experiences and integrating them at the curriculum level.

Design-Based Research (DBR) excels in iterative refinement with real learners and generates publishable insights that bridge theory and practice (Obczovsky et al. 2025). Its time-intensive nature and reliance on research infrastructure are key limitations. DBR is best applied in piloting and refining GBL interventions and producing scholarly outputs for PhD work and academic publications.

Finally, Normalization Process Theory (NPT) explains how innovations become routine and focuses on sustainability and routinization (May et al. 2009). While diagnostic rather than

prescriptive, requiring pairing with design frameworks, NPT is valuable for embedding GBL into everyday teaching and ensuring long-term institutionalization.

Four-Layer Adaptation Framework: Theory-to-Practice Mapping

We introduce the Four-Layer Adaptation Framework (illustrated in Figure 1), which integrates Ubuntu principles (Mthimkhulu 2024) and participatory culture practices to position Africa as a driving force for innovation in game-based learning. The Four-Layer Adaptation Framework was adapted from Jenkins (2009), Mthimkhulu (2024), and Mukherjee & Hammar (2018) for theoretical integration.

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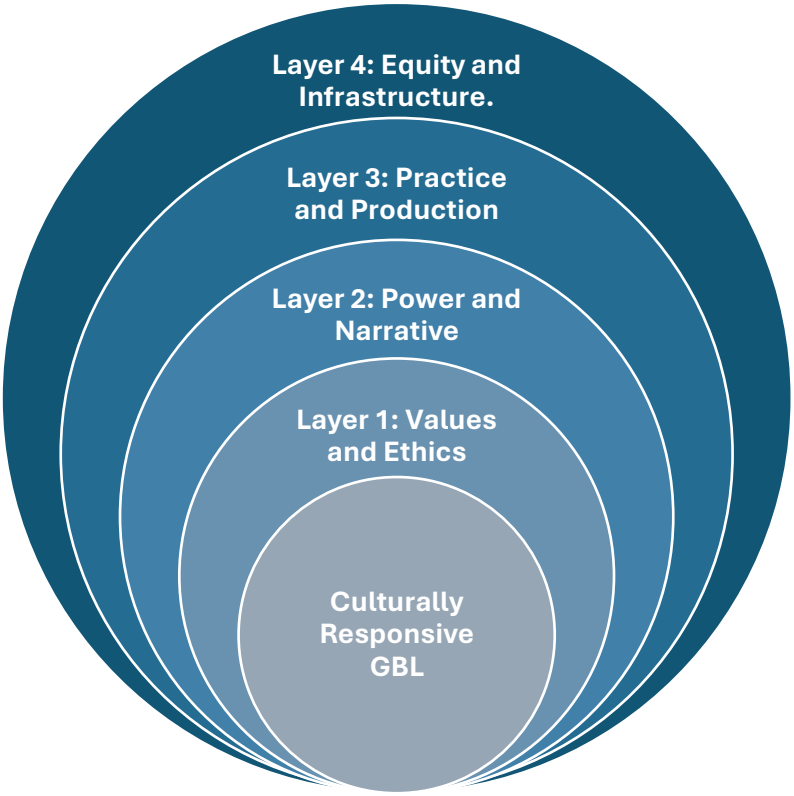


Figure 1 The Four Layer Adaptation Framework - Theory-to-Practice Mapping

The Four-Layer Adaptation Framework provides a culturally responsive and ethically grounded approach to implementing game-based learning (GBL) in African contexts. It integrates theoretical foundations with practical design implications, ensuring that pedagogical values, narrative sovereignty, participatory practices, and equity considerations are embedded throughout the adaptation process. Each layer addresses a distinct dimension of educational design, collectively forming a holistic model for transformative learning.

Layer 1: Values and Ethics (Ubuntu Pedagogy)

Grounded in Ubuntu pedagogy (Walton and Engelbrecht 2022, Mthimkhulu 2024, Ngubane and Makua 2021), this layer emphasizes interdependence, dignity, and communal care as core principles. In practice, these values translate into game mechanics that prioritize cooperation over competition, such as shared win states and collective resource systems. Feedback systems should adopt non-punitive failure loops, encouraging reflective group feedback rather than individual ranking. Language and representation must reflect cultural diversity through multilingual prompts and narratives that resonate with local identities. Assessment strategies should include group reflection journals, peer-contributed rubrics, and community impact projects. This layer is critical because it reframes engagement from competitive individualism to communal joy and solidarity, aligning GBL with African ethical frameworks.

Layer 2: Power and Narrative (Postcolonial and Decolonial Game Studies)

Drawing on postcolonial and decolonial perspectives (Fernandez and Gaur 2025), this layer foregrounds narrative sovereignty and design justice. It calls for locally authored stories and culturally grounded aesthetics to dismantle Eurocentric defaults in educational games. Game mechanics should reward cooperation and stewardship rather than extractive competition, while infrastructure must accommodate resource constraints through hybrid analog-digital formats. Evaluation metrics should prioritize cultural resonance and participatory authorship rather than speed or leaderboard rankings. This layer matters because it redistributes design power, positioning African learners as co-creators of knowledge and play, and ensuring that educational games reflect local realities and aspirations.

Layer 3: Practice and Production (Participatory Culture)

Informed by Jenkins' theory of participatory culture (Jenkins, Ito, and boyd 2015), this layer operationalizes co-creation, distributed expertise, and iterative remix as pedagogical strategies. Game development becomes a learning process, with learners actively co-designing levels, rules, and assets. Collaboration structures such as classroom guilds foster mentoring and peer-to-peer knowledge exchange. Tools should include low-bandwidth modding workflows, paper prototyping, and mobile-first design kits to ensure accessibility. Assessment should be portfolio-based, capturing design artifacts, rationales, and reflective logs. This layer is essential because it transforms game-making into a shared civic and educational practice, reinforcing Ubuntu values and advancing decolonial calls for narrative sovereignty.

Layer 4: Equity and Infrastructure (Intersectionality and Digital Divide)

The final layer addresses intersectionality and digital equity, embedding inclusive design and access-aware mechanics into GBL (Kotnana, Sulaiman, and Jesudoss 2010, Shum et al. 2023). Delivery strategies should include offline content packs, asynchronous collaboration, and micro-challenges to reduce data demands. Accessibility must align with Universal Design for Learning (UDL) principles, offering multiple means of engagement, representation, and expression. Policy alignment is crucial, requiring institutional commitments to device pools, zero-rated content, and community spaces for play. Feedback systems should provide multimodal cues and adjustable pacing to accommodate diverse learners. This layer ensures that pleasure and progress are not contingent on privilege, making equity a structural feature of GBL.

Integrated View

The Four-Layer Framework synthesizes Ubuntu pedagogy (Layer 1), postcolonial and decolonial game studies (Layer 2), participatory culture (Layer 3), and intersectionality/digital equity (Layer 4) into a coherent model for African-centric adaptation. Together, these layers create a culturally responsive, ethically grounded, and equity-driven foundation for GBL. When paired with implementation frameworks such as CFIR (Khan 2022, King et al. 2020, Durojaiye et al. 2024) or RE-AIM (Holtrop et al. 2021, King et al. 2020, Glasgow 2021), design models like TPACK (Kendon and Anselmo 2022) and UDL (Bratitsis 2023), and research methodologies such as Design-Based Research (DBR) (Isidro 2019), the framework forms a comprehensive ecosystem for scholarly rigor and practical impact.

Although this paper is conceptual, the proposed framework is intended to guide future pilot implementations of low cost DGBL in higher education. Anticipated designs include adapted commercial educational platforms, such as *Minecraft Education*, which can support scenario-based and inquiry-driven learning aligned with outcomes related to problem-solving, collaboration, and ethical reasoning (Jenkins, Ito, and boyd 2015). Low-tech and hybrid game-based approaches including board games, paper-based simulations, and role-play are also envisaged to ensure accessibility in low-resource contexts and to align with Ubuntu-oriented pedagogies that emphasise communal learning and collaboration (Walton and Engelbrecht 2022; Mthimkhulu 2024). In addition, bespoke digital micro-scenarios developed using tools such as *Articulate Storyline* will enable modular, narrative-driven learning focused on applied decision-making. Across all design types, constructive alignment with curriculum outcomes and graduate attributes is prioritised, with assessment emphasising formative feedback, reflection, and facilitated debriefing rather than high-stakes summative evaluation, consistent with inclusive and participatory GBL approaches (Jenkins 2009; Bratitsis 2023).

To support the design and implementation of these anticipated pilots, the study draws on existing internal and external expertise in GBL design and educational innovation. Institutionally, a Game-Based Learning and Gamification Working Group brings together educators with experience in gamification, simulation-based learning, and digital pedagogy, enabling peer mentoring and shared design practices. Supervisory and collaborative expertise further includes scholars with established backgrounds in GBL, participatory design, and health professions education. Pilot activity will be underpinned by a co-design and mentorship approach involving educators, GBL specialists, and students, supported by targeted training sessions and hands-on workshops focused on low-threshold tools, pedagogical alignment, and inclusive assessment strategies.

Conclusion

Adapting game-based learning for African educational contexts is not merely a matter of localization, but a systemic transformation that reimagines how play, pedagogy, and cultural identity intersect. By embedding Ubuntu principles, postcolonial and decolonial perspectives, and participatory culture practices into design, we move beyond Western-centric templates toward approaches that honour communal values, narrative sovereignty, and equity. The proposed Four-Layer Adaptation Framework offers a roadmap for this transformation, ensuring that game-based learning becomes a tool for inclusion, cultural affirmation, and social justice rather than a vehicle for epistemic dominance.

Future research and policy must prioritize co-creation, infrastructural equity, and open-source innovation to sustain this shift. In doing so, Africa can position itself as a leader in culturally responsive game design advancing educational quality, fostering joy in learning, and contributing to global conversations on decolonial pedagogy and digital equity (Keating 2024, Mota and Duarte 2026). While this paper foregrounds Ubuntu pedagogy, we do not claim that Ubuntu represents all African epistemologies. Africa encompasses diverse philosophical traditions, educational histories, and cultural practices that may not fully align with Ubuntu. The framework presented here should therefore be read as one situated as a South African informed approach rather than a universal African model.

We call African and international institutions to pivot from adapting content to adapting systems of play and care. Future work should include developing instruments to measure intersectional pleasures in African GBL, piloting multisite implementations of the adaptation framework, creating open-source libraries of culturally grounded game assets, and expanding research to non-academic contexts such as game jams and hackathons. These steps will enable a transformation that reflects African cultural values and pedagogical priorities. African contexts offer fertile ground for innovation in game studies. By integrating Ubuntu philosophy and participatory culture into GBL, we move beyond cosmetic localization toward systemic change amplifying agency, inclusivity, and joy in learning while resisting epistemic coloniality and positioning Africa as a leader in culturally responsive game design.

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